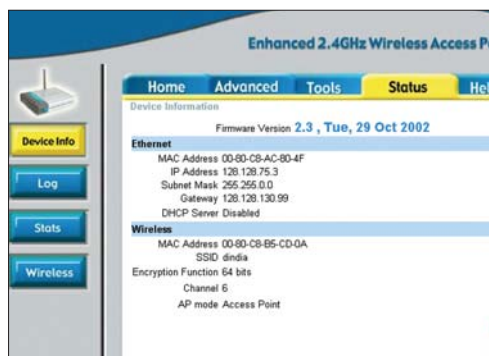


Workshop: Settings Things Up

Setting up a WLAN is really easy. However, requirements change depending on your network type. There are two ways to go about this: either you have a pure wireless LAN, where every computer is freely portable, or you share a WLAN with wired computers, in a hybrid of a wired and wireless LAN.

To configure a pure wireless network, you need to install the cards and configure them to run in ad-hoc mode, which can be done from the network connection wizard



Status is fine, all systems ready to go wireless!

in Windows XP, or the utility bundled with the adapter card. After that, install a proxy server on the computer with the Internet connection (the master) and set the others to access the Net through it. That's it—your network should be up and running.

However, a word of caution: When buying wireless hardware, make sure it's compatible—802.11b (Wi-Fi) will not work with 802.11a/g hardware. Also, wireless equipment from different vendors may or may not work together. Buy all your wireless hardware from a single vendor to avoid such problems.

Setting up a hybrid LAN is a tad more complicated. Follow these steps to connect and configure an Access Point to set up your hybrid LAN:

STEP 1 Connect the Access Point to the existing LAN with a regular RJ45 cable, which costs around Rs 50 for a 5 metre cable.

STEP 2 Power up the Access Point and access the in-built Web server by entering its IP address—for example, <http://192.168.0.1>, in the browser at the master. This will open a configuration page, from where the rest of the Access Point configuration can be done.

STEP 3 Click on the Wireless tab. There are default values assigned to various fields. Change the SSID to something else, such as Home or Wireless, and assign a network key. Set it to run in infrastructure mode and set the WEP to 64-bit from the drop-down menu.

The reason for not using 128 or 256-bit WEP encryption is that higher settings will lower the data throughput. Under the LAN tab, there's a default IP and subnet mask—do not change this. Click on the DHCP tab. Here, enable the DHCP server and assign a starting IP (say 192.168. 0.2) and ending IP, say 192.168.0.254, for the client adapter to automatically pick up IPs.

Enable DHCP only if you want the client PC to get its IP automatically, otherwise disable the DHCP server and manually assign the IPs for the client PCs.

Now, all you need to do is configure the clients.

STEP 1 Install the adapter drivers, then shut down the PC and plug the adapter card into the PCI or PCMCIA slot, and restart the system. Wait for the driver to initialise the adapter.

STEP 2 Once the hardware is initialised, double-click on the adapter card configuration icon in the system tray. This will launch the configuration utility. Here the user doesn't have to do anything, as most of the settings, including the



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